

Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes

Date: 05/21/2026

Host: Goshen Township

Call to Order: Meeting called to order at 6:29 PM by Allen Freeman with the following CCTA Officers & Active Members in attendance:

Batavia Township:

Trustee Danielle Wessel

Goshen Township:

Trustee Dan Hodges

Trustee / CCTA Vice-President Bob Hausermann

Ohio Township:

Trustee Keith Vogelsang

Trustee Scott Wolf

Pierce Township:

Trustee / CCTA President Allen Freeman

Union Township:

Trustee John Becker

Wayne Township:

Trustee Teresa Hinnners

Williamsburg Township:

Trustee Guy Bainum

Trustee Gary Jordan

Trustee Charlie Maklem

And CCTA Secretary/Treasurer Shelby Baird

The meeting initiated in Goshen Township's meeting room. Mr. Freeman welcomed everyone, and a prayer was offered by Guy Bainum. Teresa Hinnners led the group in reciting the Pledge of Allegiance. Mr. Freeman expressed thanks to Goshen Township for hosting this evening's meeting and for providing dinner. Mr. Freeman turned the floor over to Dan Hodges.

Mr. Hodges welcomed everyone and shared that dinner tonight was catered by Butterbee's. He shared that after dinner there will be a couple guest speakers, and after there will be a tour of Goshen Township's new fire station. The fire station took approximately four years to complete, and cost approximately \$8M. Dinner was setup downstairs, so Mr. Hodges invited everyone to relocate.

At approximately 7:15 PM, Mr. Freeman again called the meeting to order. Mr. Freeman asked if anyone had anything from their townships they would like to share. Mr. Freeman also congratulated John Becker on his election to the office of County Auditor.

Mr. Hodges wanted to share that they've been working very hard over the past several years to work better with their neighbors, pointing out that he and Teresa Hinnners got elected at the same time, and have cooperated very well since that time. They've been trying to assist and network with neighboring townships as much as possible and invited anyone that's new or has questions to reach out to him or

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Goshen Township Administrator Bob Rose. Goshen Township has teamed up for the first time ever with Miami Township and the Clermont County Engineer to put in a new round-about at Deerfield and Woodville. He commended the County Engineer for his gracious cooperation on that venture. He also shared that he and Guy Bainum had talked years ago about encouraging strong cooperation and support among townships, and he's pleased with how that has continued to develop.

Mr. Freeman commented about how he thinks it's positive that we'll have a new County Auditor that has recent Township experience, and that the Auditor's office has a lot of resources that can be very helpful to Townships. He reiterated again that he sees it as a very positive thing that Townships will benefit from.

Mr. Freeman then asked Mr. Baird to present the Secretary/Treasurer's reports. Mr. Baird began with the Treasurer's report, reporting that there is one outstanding check for \$200 to the Clermont County Junior Fair Board. The opening checkbook balance was \$3,068.49 and the ending balance is \$2,868.49. Mr. Freeman called for a motion to approve the Treasurer's report. Mr. Bainum moved to approve the Treasurer's report as read, seconded by Ms. Hinners. Motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Baird then asked if everyone had received the draft copies of the meeting minutes for the February 19 and March 19 meetings, asking if everyone had had a chance to review and if there were any corrections or omissions. There being none, Robert Hausermann moved to accept the minutes as presented, seconded by Danielle Wessel. Motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Freeman reminded that we have two guest speakers tonight, but before we get to them, he has a few items he wants to quickly discuss first. Then we'll move on to the guest speakers, and to the tour of the fire station.

Mr. Freeman led off with asking where we stand with the Legislative Agenda. He shared info about the status of the petition to abolish property taxes and that it seems likely there will not enough signatures to get on the ballot, however that doesn't mean Townships are out of danger. Both major candidates for governor, and still more than half the legislature, think that we should rollback, cut, or eliminate property taxes. He reminds everyone that they should still pursue securing other forms of revenue as quickly as possible. So, even if that doesn't make it to the ballot, we're still on the menu.

A question was asked about TIFs, and John Becker reminded everyone that TIFs wouldn't help in relation to property taxes, so JEDDs should be explored as an alternative. Mr. Hodges followed with a question of whether anyone has heard more detail about replacement options. Mr. Freeman shared details about things he's heard about alternative ideas, mostly focused on earnings taxes with one person even pushing the idea of removing Townships altogether. His thought is that a good solution might be to look to authorizing townships to levy earnings or sales taxes.

Mr. Freeman also acknowledged that one large aspect of the property tax issue is the school districts. He commented, followed up by Charlie Maklem, and about College Credit Plus programs and how that might impact school staffing decisions which could potentially reduce costs there. Mr. Maklem warned that even with the transition to CCP programs that the schools are still on the hook for a large portion of

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the expense so schools are better off if the work to certify their teachers for the program so the students can stay in the local school instead which helps to reduce the cost some. Mr. Maklem shared his insight from having served on the Williamsburg School Board for 10 years, and he and Mr. Freeman discussed the practicalities and drawbacks of options and how townships and school districts are so closely bound together in relation to the property tax issue.

Mr. Freeman then moved on to discuss any Zoning sub-committee activities. Teresa Hinnners shared that she'd heard the county had been awarded a grant for land use planning and that they are going to look at land use planning especially in areas where townships meet. So, townships may want to stay aware and watch for recommendations from the county.

Mr. Hodges shared that one thing they did was modify their zoning resolution to increase the minimum lot size for building to three acres from one acre in the area of Goshen Township east of Goshen Rd. They are changing the verbiage of that to work to preserve some of their land and keep that area more rural. Mr. Hausermann shared that he'd spoken with their zoning administrator who'd had a meeting with the county land use planners, and that they've discussed the county's approach to exactly that kind of question about land use and long-term planning.

Mr. Baird shared his experience, shared with Jackson, Franklin, and Williamsburg township and the meeting they'd had with the land use planners where the questions focused a lot on demographics and development problems, but the consensus from the townships focused on the lack of infrastructure and its constraint on economic development.

Ms. Hinnners shared experiences related to difficulties on zoning enforcement and nuisance properties. Mr. Freeman shared the difficulties with zoning and nuisance enforcements, and how its affected by having in-house counsel. Mr. Freeman shared thoughts on another model of how the County Engineer of Delaware County has a dedicated staff person assigned to each of their townships when there are projects going on that gives that dedicated point of contact for the township, and that it could be a good recommendation to Clermont County as an idea to improve efficiency.

Mr. Freeman moved on to Finance and Legislative sub-committee activities and thoughts. He shared thoughts on the State Capital funds and who applied for projects to be covered by it. And that we're continuing to watch the property tax issue.

Mr. Freeman shared the request from Dennis Cooper wanting to discuss HB 96 how other townships are handling those compliance requirements, also touching on the ADA/WCAG requirements. Mr. Freeman shared that Pierce isn't doing anything creative other than working with the Ohio Cybersecurity Reserve. Mr. Baird shared that Tate Township has been discussing solutions with SWOCA. Mr. Freeman asked if Mr. Baird could share that contact info to the member townships. Mr. Baird asked if everyone already had their adopting resolutions in place and adopted policies. Mr. Freeman shared that they're working on their policy implementation now. Denise Maklem and Danielle Wessel recommended that everyone look to the OTA for more resources as well. Shawn Riley, the new Clermont County EMA director, recommended that township reach out to the Ohio Cyber Reserve for more information as well.

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Mr. Freeman asked if anyone had any other ideas regarding the idea of a June/July picnic. No one had anything to share, so Mr. Freeman said based on the relatively poor reception at the last meeting that we'll move on.

Mr. Freeman shared that the fundraising and Christmas party discussion couldn't happen, but that we still want to get moving on those ideas. Time is getting shorter, so we do need to get moving on that.

Mr. Freeman shared that the next meeting is August 21st in Union Township. Mr. Freeman then turned the floor over to Bob Hausermann to introduce the first guest speaker.

Mr. Hausermann introduced Ms. Carrie Grover from Hylant Administrative Services. She's the local representative of the Ohio Plan. They are a direct competitor to OTARMA. She shared info about their company, services, and how they might be a good option for townships to consider as an alternative. At the conclusion of her presentation Mr. Hausermann shared that Hylant had offered to cover tonight's dinner, but due to logistics that wasn't able to be arranged.

Mr. Hausermann asked Mr. Baird if he could look for and get together the past letterhead that had been used in the past in relation to past fundraising activities.

Mr. Hausermann introduced the next guest speaker, Mr. Shawn Riley the new Director of the Clermont County Emergency Management Agency. Mr. Riley shared a bit of information about his experience and background. He shared info on the forthcoming updates to the EMA's Mitigation Plan, and that there will be more information coming soon.

Mr. Freeman called for a motion to adjourn. Ms. Hinnners moved to adjourn, seconded by Ms. Wessel. Meeting adjourned at 7:11 PM.